

**UNIT
4**

**DIRECT AND
INDIRECT SPEECH**

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08 REPORTED SPEECH (ALL TYPES OF SENTENCES)

• Direct Speech

Direct speech is enclosed in quotation marks, and the speaker's exact words are repeated without alteration.

Example:

- Tom said, "I am going to the market."

In direct speech, you often include a reporting verb (e.g., said, replied, asked) and use quotation marks to indicate the exact language used by the speaker.

• Indirect Speech (also known as Reported Speech)

Indirect speech involves paraphrasing what someone said without quoting them directly. This does not require quotation marks and often involves changes in verb tenses, pronouns, and other words to fit the context in which the speech is being reported. Indirect speech is used to summarize or explain someone else's words in a way that integrates smoothly with the surrounding narrative.

Example:

- Tom said that he was going to the market.

When transforming direct speech into indirect speech, several changes are necessary.

Steps to Convert Direct Speech to Indirect Speech

1. Remove the quotation marks.

2. Add "that" to connect the reporting clause and the reported speech if needed. (Check the type of sentence to place the conjunction correctly.)

• Placement of "that" depends on the type of sentence being reported:

1. Statements:

- Always place "that" after the reporting verb when converting statements to Indirect Speech.

- **Direct:** He said, "The project is due next week."

- **Indirect:** He said that the project was due the following week.

2. Questions (Yes/No):

- Do not use "that" in Yes/No questions. Instead, use if or whether to connect the clauses.

- **Direct:** She asked, "Do you like pizza?"

- **Indirect:** She asked if I liked pizza.

3. Questions (Wh-):

- Do not use "that" to connect Wh- questions. Use the Wh- word directly.
- **Direct:** He asked, "What are you doing this weekend?"
- **Indirect:** He asked what I was doing that weekend.

4. Commands and Requests:

- Do not use "that" in commands or requests. Use to + verb instead.
- **Direct:** She said, "Please send the report."
- **Indirect:** She asked me to send the report.

Examples

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
"We are moving to a new city," she said.	She said that they were moving to a new city.
"Did you see the movie?" he asked.	He asked if I had seen the movie.
"Why are you late?" she asked.	She asked why I was late.
"I am tired," he said.	He said that he was tired.
"Are you coming?" she said.	She asked if I was coming.
"Bring your books tomorrow," he said.	He told me to bring my books the next day.

Rules for Adjusting Pronouns

1. First Person Pronouns (I, We, Me, Us):

- Change to match the subject of the reporting clause (the reporter).
- **Direct:** She said, "We are excited about the trip."
- **Indirect:** She said that they were excited about the trip.

2. Second Person Pronouns (You, Your):

- Change to match the listener or object of the reporting clause (the person being addressed).
- **Direct:** He said, "You need to finish this."
- **Indirect:** He said that I needed to finish this.

3. Third Person Pronouns (He, She, It, They, Their, His, Her):

- Generally, third-person pronouns do not change because they already refer to others.
- **Direct:** She said, "He can join us later."
- **Indirect:** She said that he could join them later.

Tense Changes in Indirect Speech

When the reporting verb is in the past tense, the tense in the reported speech typically changes accordingly.

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech	Example
Present Simple	Past Simple	"I go to school," she said. → She said that she went to school.
Present Continuous	Past Continuous	"We are studying," he said. → He said that they were studying.
Present Perfect	Past Perfect	"I have lost my keys," she said. → She said that she had lost her keys.
Present Perfect Continuous	Past Perfect Continuous	"I have been working," he said. → He said that he had been working.
Past Simple	Past Perfect	"They bought a new car," he said. → He said that they had bought a new car.
Past Continuous	Past Perfect Continuous	"I was cooking dinner," he said. → He said that he had been cooking dinner.
Past Perfect	No Change	"I had seen the movie," she said. → She said that she had seen the movie.
Past Perfect Continuous	No Change	"I had been studying," he said. → He said that he had been studying.
Future Simple (will)	Would	"I will help you later," she said. → She said that she would help me later.

Change of Time/Place Words

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
This	That
These	Those
Here	There
Now	Then
Today	That day
Tonight	That night
Tomorrow	The next day
Yesterday	The day before/ the previous day
Next week	The following week
Last week	The previous week
Ago	Before

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
"I will do it today," he said.	He said that he would do it that day.
"You should take rest," he said.	He advised me to take rest.
"We met last year," they said.	They said that they had met the year before.

Exercise: 1

Change the following sentences into the indirect narration of speech.

1. She said, "I like clouds in the sky."
2. He said, "I am unwell."
3. He said to her, "I live in this building."
4. They said, "Our teacher is on leave."
5. Ali and Ayesha said to their mother, "We like mangoes."
6. She said, "I am helping my mother in the kitchen."
7. He said, "I am watering the plants in the garden."
8. Hassan said, "I am sewing mother's shirt."
9. He said, "They are not doing their duty well."
10. He said to me, "You are not running very fast."
11. They said, "We have done our duty."
12. The teacher said to us, "You have not completed your drawing."
13. She said, "They have not eaten their meals."
14. The teacher said, "I have often told you not to play with fire."
15. My brother said to me, "You have missed the point completely."
16. He said, "I completed my drawing half an hour ago."
17. She said, "I did not go to school yesterday."
18. He said, "She sang a beautiful ghazal at the concert last night."
19. She said, "He rang me up at twelve midnight."
20. He said, "The boys did not put up a good show last night."
21. She said, "I shall never do such a thing."
22. Sami said, "They will wait for us for an hour only."
23. They said, "We shall never make a promise we cannot fulfil."
24. He said, "I shall explain this to you only if you listen to me with patience."
25. He said, "I hope you will not repeat this mistake."

Exercise: 2

Change the following sentences into the indirect narration of speech.

1. She said, "Is this your book?"
2. He said, "Do you have any share in this firm?"
3. They said, "Have you ever visited Murree Hills?"
4. He said, "Are you ashamed of your behaviour?"
5. The teacher said, "Did you do your home task yesterday?"
6. The mother said, "Didn't I ask you not to go there?"
7. Ayesha said, "Will you stop interfering in my work?"
8. The mother said, "Shall we invite the Qureshis also?"
9. Saad said, "Had you left Karachi before writing this letter?"
10. The judge said, "Have you anything more to say?"
11. He said, "What do you want me to do?"
12. The mother said, "How did you fail in your examination?"
13. Zain said, "Where are you going?"
14. The teacher said, "Whose book is it?"
15. The teacher said, "Who is the author of this book?"
16. The stranger said, "Which is the way to the Shalimar Garden?"
17. The manager said, "How do you propose to solve this problem?"
18. The boy said, "What do you want me to do?"
19. The pupil said, "Where have I ceased?"
20. The teacher said, "Who is next on the list?"

Exercise: 3

Change the following into indirect narration.

1. He said to his sister, "Please say something."
2. She said to her friends, "Please have dinner with me tomorrow at eight."
3. The judge said, "Call the next witness."
4. Ali said to his uncle, "Please help me in getting some job."
5. The doctor said to the patient, "Take complete rest and follow my directions."
6. The teacher said to the pupil, "Read the paragraph and explain it in simple English."

7. The mother said to her daughter, "Please tidy up your room."
8. She said to me, "Do not waste your time in idle talk."
9. The father said to his son, "Get up early in the morning and go for a walk."
10. Ali said, "Let us go for a picnic on Friday."
11. He said to his friend, "Please lend me your bike for a day."
12. He said to her, "Please fetch me a glass of water."
13. The master said to the servant, "Go and fetch me a glass of milk."
14. The father said to his son, "Do not leave this room without my permission."
15. She said to them, "Let us not deceive ourselves."

Exercise: 4

Change the following into the indirect form of narration.

1. She said to her father, "May you live long!"
2. She said, "May you prosper!"
3. The mother said to her daughter, "May Allah bless you with a son!"
4. She said, "Would that my father were alive!"
5. The mother said to her son, "May you return successful!"
6. She said, "What a beautiful piece of art!"
7. He said, "How well she sings!"
8. He said, "Alas! We cannot defeat our enemies."
9. She said, "What a pity you missed that function!"
10. He said, "Hurrah! I have won the medal."

Exercise: 5

Change the following into the indirect form of narration.

1. They say, "We have done our duty."
2. She says, "We have shifted to another house."
3. The teacher will say, "You have done your work very well."
4. He says, "She has written me a very encouraging letter."
5. She says, "We love and respect our neighbours very much."
6. She has said, "She is ready to accompany us to Karachi."
7. He says, "I have not heard the latest news about her."
8. The doctor says, "The patient is still in a state of coma."
9. The teacher says, "She has always been a good student."
10. She will say, "He did not come up to my expectations."